searing religious tensions. Mehta's benchmark study deftly brings together the freshness and vigour of on-the-ground reporting with scholarly precision and vivid descriptions of India's political, economic and social systems. An urgent investigation of Indian democracy, its electoral system and voting patterns; written with anthropological attentiveness to local idioms, gender structure, caste conflict and class relations: a major achievement.'

—**Professor Assa Doron**, Professor of Anthropology and South Asia,
Founding Director, South Asia Centre,
Australian National University, Canberra

'This is a remarkably well-researched and thoughtfully constructed account of the rise of the BJP under Prime Minister Modi. It is a book that must be read by any political scientist interested in post-1991 India. Its use of textual and quantitative data is a brilliant example of empirical academic work. It will greatly improve the discourse on India's political economy.'

—**Professor Shubhashis Gangopadhyay**, Dean, Indian School of Public
Policy; Visiting Professor, University of Gothenberg, Sweden;
Visiting Professor, University of Groningen, Netherlands

'Nalin's work in this book re-establishes hope in the future of political journalism in the country. For a variety of reasons, some well-known and some less-known, political journalism in India has been losing its bite and its objectivity. Nalin combines deep data analysis, extensive research, wonderful ground reporting and balanced perspective in a crisp text with attractive charts to show how to inform and engage people with political writing even in these polarised times. This book is a must-read for anyone looking to look beyond the noise and understand modern India. It will appeal to diverse audiences: specialist as well as general.'

—**Rohit Saran**, Chief Editor, Times Internet

'Nalin Mehta's wonderful book on the BJP is a dispassionate inquiry into the genesis of the Hindutva mind space. Delineating a complete